

Interviewer: [00:00:00 - 00:00:04] Well, welcome back.

Speaker: [00:00:05 - 00:00:08] So wait a minute, am I supposed to say on the screen that I understand this?

Interviewer: [00:00:09] Yeah.

Speaker: [00:00:09 - 00:00:10] Something came up.

Interviewer: [00:00:10] Recording.

Speaker: [00:00:10] Okay.

Interviewer: [00:00:11 - 00:00:12] I told you I recorded it.

Speaker: [00:00:12 - 00:00:13] Got it, okay.

Interviewer: [00:00:14 - 00:00:18] So Interview, can you confirm that you have read the consent form and that you have voluntarily participated in the interview?

Speaker: [00:00:19 - 00:00:20] I confirm.

Interviewer: [00:00:21 - 00:00:22] How old are you?

Speaker: [00:00:23 - 00:00:25] How old do I show? (laughs)

Interviewer: [00:00:28 - 0:30] So, what is it?

Speaker: [56-60].

Interviewer: [00:00:32 - 00:00:35] How long have you been together with your spouse?

Speaker: [00:00:36 - 00:00:40] So it's been [26-30] years, so it will be [26-30] in [Month].

Interviewer: [00:00:41 - 00:00:42] Do you have children?

Speaker: [00:00:43 - 00:00:46] There is a [26-30]-old girl.

Interviewer: [00:00:48 - 00:00:50] Who do you live with at home?

Speaker: [00:00:51 - 00:01:07] For the last [1-5] years, my mother has been involved with us after my father passed away. That's how it is. I mean, there is also my daughter, but my daughter is mostly staying with her boyfriend at the moment.

Interviewer: [00:01:08 - 00:01:10] Your mother, your wife and you at home mostly?

Speaker: [00.01:11] Yeah.

Interviewer: [00.01:13 - 00:01:17] What is your main source of income? What do you do for a living?

Speaker: [00:01:18 - 00:01:42] Well, I am a retired [occupation], I used to be a [occupation], so I have a pension from that. I also did [occupation] then, from [location] as a [location]. Well, when that was over, now I'm doing something in the [business] with our own little money.

Interviewer: [00.01:44 - 00:1:48] I address your wife as your wife. Would you like me to address you in another way?

Speaker: [00:01:49 - 00:01:52] No, I mean you can say her name.

Interviewer: [00:01:54 - 00:01:58] Would you like to tell me the story of how you met and how your relationship started?

Speaker: [00:01:59 - 00:02:07] The story of our meeting started in the [company], she was a [occupation]. So, should I tell you a long story?

Interviewer: [00:02:07 - 00:02:08] However you want to put it.

Speaker: [00:02:10 - 00:03:00] So, in the [company], [redacted]. Well, we always came across the same thing, coincidence. And since there was a lot of talking in the session, I asked him if he had any gum, if he had any candy, and so on. Just like that, shopping and shopping. We also have a mutual girlfriend. She said, "Oh," she said, he asked about me, she said I am a very sweet girl. So I asked about him and she said he's a cute guy too. That's how we started.

Interviewer: [00:03:00 - 00:03:02] And then it turned into a relationship? Yes.

Speaker: [00:03:03 - 00:04:29] So we went out to dinner and stuff. Then it was a movie or something, classic stuff. And then yes, we went on vacation, blah blah blah. That's how things developed. And heh, let me tell you this, the real punchline. I don't know, maybe my husband told you (laughs). Well, our first date. Our first dinner date, yes, exactly. We were drinking, drinking [drink], blah blah blah. He said, well, we hadn't even held hands yet. My hand was on the table. He reached for my hand and said "what do you think about our relationship?" Relationship (laughs)? What relationship, I mean there was no relationship, we just started. I said, I don't know, I don't know, just chit-chat. And he looked me in the eye, he said, "I think much more". Anyway, after a month or so we went on a vacation. Well, we planned to get married there anyway. So it happened very quickly. He went to the [occupation]. Then we got married. But age probably had something to do with it. How old were we then? We were [26-30], [26-30]. After that, you know, everyone around us got married. Then, because everyone else had children, we had children too. It was a bit like herd psychology.

Speaker: [00:04:30 - 00:04:32] It proceeded as part of normative processes.

Interviewer: [00:04:33] Yeah.

Interviewer: [00:04:36 - 00:04:43] How would you rate the quality of your own relationship compared to the relationships of your friends, compared to the relationships of your acquaintances?

Speaker: [00:04:46 - 00:05:06] So. It's such a relative thing. Because, they are. I mean, there are those who say things like "Oh, we are very happy" and stuff. But I know the reality, for example, I'm talking to his wife.

Interviewer: [00:05:06] Hmm.

Speaker: [00:05:06 - 00:05:18] I don't know, or my husband says it. You know, it's the same for us. Of course, I mean, this [30-35] years of togetherness. Of course it is very difficult.

Interviewer: [00:05:18] Hmm.

Speaker: [00:05:19 - 00:06:09] In the same house. But we had a lot in common. I mean, of course it was better at first. You know, the relationship wears out in time. There were fights and

stuff like that. Uh-huh. We had a lot in common. There was the [company] once. We were at the same workplace. We would come home and we could talk about work, we could open our wine and chat, blah, blah, blah. But over time, you know, we, now you asked about the relationship of our friends. I mean, let me tell you about myself first. It turned into friendship. You know, we're like two friends sharing the same house now.

Interviewer: [00:06:11 - 00:06:12] Like a roommate.

Speaker: [00:06:12 - 00:06:14] Yes, yes. That's right.

Interviewer: [00:06:15 - 00:06:17] Why like roommates?

Speaker: [00:06:17 - 00:06:36] Because, I think he doesn't accept it, but you know, he has changed a lot. I mean, of course, this is a process related to getting older, I mean, when you get older, your character changes. Uh-huh. I mean, I don't know. Huh. I don't know, I guess it wasn't very clear.

Interviewer: [00:06:37 - 00:07:16] I will get to the questions I will ask later, but I would still like to ask you for a comparison. I realize, it is not easy to compare. You don't witness what people's relationships are from behind. There are pretenses and so on. But I don't expect an objective answer anyway, I'm curious about your subjective answer. If you were to compare, even though it's hard to compare, how would you compare? We are better. We are worse. We are not average. People's relationships are a disaster. Ours are at least going somehow. I'm writing now.

Speaker: [00:07:16 - 00:07:26] So there is also something like this. For example, according to one couple we are very good, according to another couple we are average. I mean, now that we have a wide circle.

Interviewer: [00:07:27] Hmm.

Speaker: [00:07:28 - 00:08:00] But what should I say. I'll say average. I wasn't very sure, so I'll call it average. Maybe we were much, much, much better than them at the beginning according to certain time periods. Then maybe we started to decline. Maybe they went up at that time. But right now, it's stable. Something. Relationship

Interviewer: [00:08:00 - 00:08:11] Right. You are right that it is also a temporal question. It doesn't always stay the same. Since you talked about changing, let me start by asking the questions of change. Has this relationship changed you?

Speaker: [00:08:14 - 00:08:30] So. It must have changed me. I mean, I can't say "no, it hasn't changed, I'm the same as I was that day". Of course, of course it changed me. In fact, it has clearly changed right now.

Interviewer: [00:08:30 - 00:08:32] In what ways did it change?

Speaker: [00:08:33 - 00:11:14] So, in what ways? Maybe I became a little bit more aggressive, because REDACTED (his husband's name) became very angry. Uh-huh. I'm a [Zodiac Sign], by the way, I don't know, does it matter? Well, I always choose to look at things logically. I'm sorry (coughs). I started to ignore it. You know, because we were fighting. No, I was explaining this and that. But it's such an exhausting process. You know, because he doesn't accept it either. I pass it off or I don't give a damn anymore. You know, these marriages of over [16-20] years.

You know, a happy marriage. I mean, it could be a question mark that we are happy. After all, you know, our [30-35] years have been so beautiful and wonderful. There was no such thing. You probably wouldn't believe me if I said that. How many couples have already achieved this? Well, and let me put it this way, we are a very modern couple. Even though my husband is more conservative. But we both have something in common. You know, we have free spaces. I go out with girls, he goes out with his college friends. Of course, we also do things together. I meet those college students too, after all. We also do things with them and their wives and so on and so forth. Well, but if you ask me, especially in the last [1-5] years, we have gone on vacation together maybe once. Even always on vacation, you know, separately. Because, you know, his work situation, my mom's health problems at home, and so on. Because of that kind of things, you know, not being able to make time. And the last time we went on vacation, [1-5] or [6-10] years ago, we were fighting a lot. I mean, with everything. So, for example, I don't know, I think this is a big thing, my husband snores. We don't sleep together because he snores. Since we can't sleep together, some things don't happen anymore. Well, so, you know, it is like that. Everyone lives their own life, honestly.

Interviewer: [00:11:17 - 00:11:19] In what ways has he changed? Has he changed?

Speaker: [00:11:20] REDACTED?

Interviewer: [00:11:21] Hmm (confirming).

Speaker: [00:11:22 - 00:12:41] In what ways has he changed? Well, I can say that he became a completely different man. I mean, he was like a delight. He was very sweet like that. Well, he is very witty, funny. He is loved by everyone. Well, blah, blah, blah, blah, but he's very nice to the outside world, especially because everyone loves him so much. If someone like that wants something, for example, there was a couple we used to see. We don't see them now. They were our friends for [30-35] years. You know, our children grew up together and so on and so forth. You know, if he asks for something, of course it happens immediately. I mean, no matter how ridiculous he asks for something, just so as not to offend him. I mean, if I ask for something very simple, it can be like, oh REDACTED don't be ridiculous or something like that. I mean, and these things break me over time, and they will break me because when I tell him, he says there is no such thing. He says that I misunderstand, blah blah blah. You know, he is very special to the outside, but not to us, for example. That's why he has changed a lot, a lot. And I don't want to, I don't know, I don't want to obsess over it and get depressed.

Interviewer: [00:12:45 - 00:12:48] What makes a relationship quality?

Speaker: [00:12:51 - 00:12:53] Understanding each other.

Interviewer: [00:12:55 - 00:12:56] Can you explain more?

Speaker: [00:12:58 - 00:13:17] So, as I explained before, we don't get along. You know how they always say things like love (sevgi), respect, trust of course. You know, being peaceful, I think. When you already understand each other, there is trust, there is love (sevgi), there is peace, there is everything.

Interviewer: [00:13:18] Hmm.

Speaker: [00:13:20 - 00:13:25] But if you don't understand each other, if you are not on the same wavelength, there is no point. You know.

Interviewer: [00:13:28 - 00:13:31] You are saying that if you are not on the same frequency, the rest of the things don't happen.

Speaker: [00:13:32 - 00:13:38] It doesn't work, you can't make it happen, so some things don't feel like it.

Interviewer: [00:13:41 - 00:13:44] What makes a relationship low quality?

Speaker: [00:13:46 - 00:13:49] That's the opposite of what I just mentioned. So (laughs).

Interviewer: [00:13:50 - 00:13:53] Not understanding. Understanding and not understanding.

Speaker: [00:13:53 - 00:14:01] Not understanding, thinking of yourself, not being special. Well, I mean.

Interviewer: [00:14:03 - 00:14:06] May I ask how many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker: [00:14:07 - 00:14:32] Romantic (stretching the syllables). Romantic. Well, I was already engaged before my husband. Uh, he was my childhood friend. We were engaged for [1-5] years, blah blah blah. Then he cheated on me, classic. So I broke up with him. Well, then, before that, you know, what can I say, romantically, how can I say? Maybe, uh, there was someone else. There were two or three people.

Interviewer: [00:14:35 - 00:14:41] Compared to those relationships, how would you rate the quality of those relationships, your relationship now?

Speaker: [00:14:42 - 00:15:09] But they were very childish, I mean youth relationships. I mean, how can I compare [30-35] years with the one I dated for a couple of years? It didn't happen... (Unintelligible). Anyway, you know, if I had, I would have married them, you know ... (Unintelligible) if you ask?

Interviewer: [00:15:09 - 00:15:10] If you ask what?

Speaker: [00:15:11 - 00:15:48] Why did you choose REDACTED? Why did you get married? If you ask? Well, you know, think of a glass of water. A person like that. He doesn't lie, he is like an open book. Well, you know he can't. You can understand when he's lying. He can't do it at all. For example, if we were going to do something with our friends. He doesn't want to go, he wants me to tell them. He says "I can't say no". I mean, it's always me, I'm the bad cop, he's the good cop. That's how it is. I mean, more because he's honest. I married him because he's good. I preferred him.

Interviewer: [00:15:54 - 00:16:04] Understanding, understanding. Do you want to explain a little bit more what it means? How does one get along? How can one not get along?

Speaker: [00:16:09 - 00:16:28] How does one get along? I mean, if they have common tastes. Like I said, if they are on the same wavelength, you can get along. I mean, this doesn't only apply to a couple. I mean, it's the same with my friend. I mean, I'm sure you have a lot of friends that you never wanted to meet, that you got over.

Interviewer: [00:16:28] Hmm.

Speaker: [00:16:29 - 00:16:31] Well, I think it's about being on the same page

Interviewer: [00:16:37 - 00:17:07] Could you explain these two words a little more? Being on the same wavelength, being on the same page. I mean, I'm not asking because I don't understand anything, I understand something, but it's a frequently used word, being on the same wavelength, being on the same page, it's like a phrase, like an idiom. We both understand something, but I am asking to better understand what you mean, what do you mean? What does it include?

Speaker: [00:17:10 - 00:18:12] So what does it include? Enjoying the common life, the common, I mean like the music you listen to. He likes [genre] and I like [genre] music, for example. Well, this has also changed over time. For a while we used to go to [genre] bars in [Location] and we were in such a state, you know, like I said, maybe it has something to do with age. It has something to do with getting older, but now, for example, he turns on fc in the car, that is, he [redacted] (imitation of singing song lyrics). I can't take them and when I tell him to turn it off, he yells at me angrily. You know, we're going from here to the street, it's a 15-20 minute drive, listen to it the rest of the time, don't turn it on when I'm in the car, I don't want that, for example. Something can come out even from there. You know, I think taste in music is more like taste in food, I mean taste in drink, you know, everything you share, to be in the same mindset and wavelength.

Interviewer: [00:18:14 - 00:18:18] Sharing similar tastes, similar hobbies, similar joys.

Speaker: [00:18:19 - 00:18:50] Of course. For example, there is something I am very angry about. It happened earlier in the morning. For example, he watches something, he watches a magazine on TV. He does excessive body shaming. He does it with women and men. What are you, like are you a big deal? Oh, this one is like this, that one is like this, and so on. He's always been a critical person. He criticizes everything. I'm here now like a [occupation], I'm pouring my heart out, but I don't know how useful it will be for you (laughs).

Interviewer: [00:18:52 - 00:19:09] Everything you say is valuable for us. That's exactly why instead of giving a questionnaire, we are conducting interviews to capture all the richness that comes naturally. So whatever you want to say is important.

Speaker: [00:19:09 - 00:19:11] It's a relief (laughs).

Interviewer: [00:19:14] I'm glad.

Speaker: [00:19:15 - 00:19:17] Let's meet sometime, I don't know (Location).

Interviewer: [00:19:20 - 00:19:23] Hmm. What is love to you?

Speaker: [00:19:25 - 00:20:09] Love. Love. I think it's passion, but it's also about hormones, so love (aşk) ends and love (sevgi) remains. Well, that first attraction, being together, wanting each other, missing each other, blah blah blah, I think it's something related to that. Well, it's that feeling when you have butterflies in your stomach, when the curtain comes down on your eyes and you don't see anything, blah blah blah. Well, but of course it has a lifespan too. You know, there is no love (aşk) persisting [46-50] years, it's love (sevgi), respect.

Interviewer: [00:20:13 - 00:20:16] How important is love for a relationship?

Speaker: [00:20:19 - 00:21:00] How important is it? Well, but are we talking about love (aşk) in the sense that I'm talking about love (aşk) or what kind of love are we talking about? I mean, I think it as passion, I think it as sexuality for example. Well, I think it's very important. It's eighty

percent of it, I think. I mean, it's the same mindset, the same wavelength, of course, but think of it like this. If there is no sex, if there is no sexuality in the relationship, as I said, you become two friends who share the same house like us.

Interviewer: [00:21:03 - 00:21:07] While we're on the subject, can I ask you a few questions about sexuality?

Speaker: [00:21:07] Of course.

Interviewer: [00:21:10 - 00:21:13] Are you satisfied with your sex life, how satisfied are you?

Speaker: [00:21:15 - 00:21:20] So we have no sex life. So I am very pleased (laughs).

Interviewer: [00:21:20 - 00:21:23] You say how can I be satisfied with something that is not there?

Speaker: [00:21:23 - 00:21:35] I mean. I mean, let me put it this way, something like that used to happen once every [1-5] years, but then I went through menopause, I honestly don't have such an extreme desire.

Interviewer: [00:21:36 - 00:21:48] How does it feel to you, the absence? No desire, no inclination? What is it like to live without sexuality?

Speaker: [00:21:50 - 00:22:23] I mean, the times we had were good, but then I don't know, like everything else, I guess it has its time. So it ends. After all, I'm [56-60] years old, okay, there must be people who have sex at this age. Maybe if someone came across me, maybe it would be like that, but I mean. You know, because desires are over, mutual things, I can't say that I'm looking for it so much.

Interviewer: [00:22:30 - 00:22:36] ... (unintelligible) since I asked ... (unintelligible). What are the most important things in a relationship for you?

Speaker: [00:22:37 - 00:22:38] Sorry, I didn't hear the beginning.

Interviewer: [00:22:38 - 00:22:46] What is the most important thing in a relationship for you? What are the most important things? We talked about being understood.

Speaker: [00:22:46 - 00:24:15] Yes. Trust, peace. Peace, I mean peace. Well, let's put it this way. REDACTED is an obsessive person even though he doesn't admit it. Well, I mean, he comes home and before he even takes off his shoes from work, I mean, our kitchen is just to the left of the entrance, he comes into the kitchen and looks at the dishwasher. You know, how did we put the glasses, is this the way to put them? He goes off on us, on my mom and me. Well, I'm very good at stacking the dishwasher. By the way, let me give you this information. I don't know how useful it is. You know, he moves the glasses I put in, and then I put them back the way they were, because after all, I'm running the machine, so I'm doing the final. That's how he's happy. I don't say anything to him anymore. I say fine, you put it where you want, I'll do it again anyway. That's why we were having so many fights. For example, that's why I always say peace and understanding. Well, of course, trust is a very important thing in a relationship, but I mean, let's not trust him anymore if he's going to yell at me, if he's going to talk about the dishwasher, I mean, I want to be peaceful, I don't want to fight anymore. That's why I don't want to trust him. Okay, I trust him, but I don't need to trust him.

Interviewer: [00:24:17 - 00:24:21] Can you elaborate, what do you mean you don't want to trust?

Speaker: [00:24:21 - 00:24:53] You know, trust. What do I mean by trust here? You know, cheating, being with someone else, lying, and so on and so forth. So many things. A lot of things break trust, I don't care at all. He can do whatever he wants. As you can see, in marriages of more than twenty years, it is not a big deal (Güler).

Interviewer: [00:24:55 - 00:24:57] You seem to be struggling.

Speaker: [00:24:59 - 00:25:50] Well, of course, it is very clear. Then my husband's economic situation was not good. He wasn't working. Well, we could have gotten divorced, but he didn't prefer it and neither did I because somehow there is something holding us together. You know, there is something that binds us to each other. You know, for example, I go on vacation for [1-5] days and [1-5] days, I go to my friend's summer house, you know, and when I come back, you know, I miss him, I miss him. I mean, I love him, of course. Well, you know, I'm looking for him sometimes. You know, not everything is over after all.

Interviewer: [00:25:54 - 00:25:56] What's left, what's left?

Speaker: [00:25:57 - 00:26:48] The rest. So there's love (sevgi), I love (seviyorum). So there's no respect, I think. Well, I mean. I mean, maybe there is a little respect. Well, yes, but I mean, because in a place where I'm yelled at and shouted at so much, there's no respect left, I mean. So what else is there? I mean sometimes, usually [1-5] times a week, we like to drink together. We have a drink, we put on music, we chat, I mean we agree on those things, there is no problem.

Interviewer: [00:26:54 - 00:27:01] How do you know if your partner loves you? How do people know if they are loved?

Speaker: [00:27:02 - 00:27:16] You can tell. You can tell from a look, a gesture, a word he says, so it's not necessarily buying a gift or doing something, it can be small gestures, it can be anything.

Interviewer: [00:27:18 - 00:27:21] you say it is intuitive.

Speaker: [00:27:21 - 00:27:23] Exactly. So your eye ...

Interviewer: [00:27:25 - 00:27:27] So you know how he/she looks at you.

Speaker: [00:27:33 - 00:27:56] We talked a little bit about what are the difficulties in your relationship, that you often argue, that you argue about order and the way things are done. That you argue about the differences in your dep, in your dep. We talked about the shouting at home.

Interviewer: [00:27:58] Yeah.

Interviewer: [00:27:59 - 00:28:02] Is there anything else we would like to add in relation to your challenges?

Speaker: [00:28:08 - 00:28:26] Well, I mean like this. The things I said, but if you have something to ask, it can be in the form of a question and answer. I can't think of much right now, but maybe if you ask, for example, do you agree on this or that?

Interviewer: [00:28:27 - 00:28:30] Let me ask you how often do you argue?

Speaker: [00:28:30 - 00:28:41] Every day, you know, every day, every day. I mean, of course we are not daggers drawn.

Interviewer: [00:28:41] Hmm.

Speaker: [00:28:42 - 00:29:41] There is always tension over something, something very simple. For example, why is this glass standing here? If you are very uncomfortable, put it away. You know, I didn't see it. I mean, for example, we have a lot of fights and things like that, but then, for example, my daughter always says, I can't believe it, she says you guys yell at each other, you know, you yell at each other, we swear at each other, it lasts for ten minutes or something, ten minutes later she says, oh dear, can you do this and that. She says how can you become like this? You know, we have such a situation. For example, he opens a glass of wine and says, "Can I pour you a glass, dear? You know what happened, ten minutes ago we were shouting at each other, we said words to each other. He says, "How can you go on as if it didn't happen?

Interviewer: [00:29:42 - 00:29:44] How can you continue?

Speaker: [00:29:44 - 00:30:20] (Laughs) That's a good question. I don't know. I ignore it. Also, you know, you get used to it and as I said, you don't bark. I don't know, I'm already hurt, we hurt each other and I hurt him, but then somehow, for example, according to my daughter, she says, well, the bond between you, the love between you is very strong, she says that since it lasted for so many years and you couldn't do anything, she says, well, you don't divorce. I mean, she says that there is something holding us together.

Interviewer: [00:30:23 - 00:30:26] How do you resolve these disputes?

(spoken at the same time)

Speaker: [00:30:31 - 00:31:16] It's not solved. It's not solved and it's always the same thing, I mean it's always the same thing. I mean I've said a thousand times, man, don't go into the dishwasher, I mean why do you have to go in there, is there a need? That's our biggest fight. We were so happy for [1-5] weeks when it broke down. I didn't want it to be done, so I washed the dishes by hand. Really, the problem is over. I mean, I like washing dishes by hand. You know, the water, the foam. You know, it's like a therapy for me. I said okay, the machine shouldn't be used. He said, "Don't be ridiculous, okay? As it was already done, we started to fight again.

Interviewer: [00:31:17] Hmm.

Speaker: [00:31:18 - 00:31:21] The biggest culprit in the house is actually the dishwasher.

Interviewer: [00:31:24 - 00:31:26] It's good to have detected it at least.

Speaker: [00:31:27] Yeah.

(Unintelligible)

Speaker: [00:31:29 - 00:31:32] Yes. Yes, that's exactly what it is.

Interviewer: [00:31:33 - 00:31:41] So am I understanding correctly? You are saying that problems are ignored rather than solved.

Speaker: [00:31:41] Of course it is.

Interviewer: [00:31:41 - 00:31:45] That it was destroyed, as if it didn't exist.

Speaker: [00:31:44 - 00:31:45] Exactly. Like it didn't happen.

Interviewer: [00:31:51] Like playing peekaboo

Speaker: [00:31:52 - 00:32:00] Yes, yes, it's like a flame of straw, I mean, it flashes on and off like that, so we have such a situation.

Interviewer: [00:32:06 - 00:32:16] What are the ways to maintain a relationship? What are the ways to sustain a relationship? How do relationships last?

Speaker: [00:32:18 - 00:32:20] How last? So is it for us or is it general?

Interviewer: [00:31:21 - 00:32:24] Both. Let's start with you.

Speaker: [00:32:25 - 00:33:14] So for us, you know, we can make an inference from what we have already talked about. You know, to say how it will last in general, with understanding. With mutual understanding, I mean, I think this is the biggest basis. Understanding is really very important for me, I mean, it is very important to understand each other, and in a peaceful environment, I mean, maybe I said this word a lot. I am always looking for peace, but I am looking for peace, I mean, I don't want tension in my life anymore. That's why, for example, I can run away and go on vacation, fortunately my friend has a house. So I go and I reset my mind and come back.

Interviewer: [00:33:19 - 00:33:22] Would you say that this relationship is good for you?

Speaker: [00:33:25 - 00:33:25] Is it now?

Interviewer: [00:33:27 - 00:33:34] Right now, until today. Which one do you want to answer?

Speaker: [00:33:35 - 00:33:53] It was good at first, it was good. Then it went down and now it is stable. I mean, am I satisfied now? Of course, of course, I mean, I'm not perfectly satisfied, but I'm not damn it or not, I'm in between.

Interviewer: [00:34:00 - 00:34:07] Let me ask you, what continues to feel good, does it continue to feel good?

Speaker: [00:34:07 - 00:35:32] There is a habitual order, well, for example, if there was someone, I'm going out with my friends, we're having a girls' night out, you're going to play cards. I mean, someone who interferes with them, like no, you can't go, you can't do that. I am already a [Zodiac Sign], I am very fond of my freedom. You know, as soon as I felt that I was restricted, I mean, I would leave no matter what. Ha Ha, right now he is hanging out and I am hanging out, so it's not much of a problem. Since I am already the dominant one in the relationship, I can say that what I want happens. When it doesn't happen, problems arise. When what I want is not done, there can be problems, but by the way, my husband is the selfish one in the relationship. I mean, he is selfish but he pretends to be harmonious, he tries to get his own

way, you know, I always try to find a common ground. You know, what I meant by dominant is that I don't let myself be interfered with the things I want to do, I don't want it. For example.

Interviewer: [00:35:33 - 00:35:35] You seem to be talking about drawing boundaries.

Speaker: [00:35:35 - 00:38:38] Well, for example, I like to wake up late. He is also a person who can get up very early in the morning, and he has diabetes. Especially on Sunday mornings, he wants to have breakfast early and eat something as soon as possible. When I wake up, I can't have breakfast right away, you know, let me drink my coffee, let me recover, let me not talk, let no one ask me anything. It's like they don't know me, and I hate being woken up. Especially at the weekend, he comes and makes noise, that's disrespectful, disrespectful to the sleeper, first of all, no matter what. If I don't wake up, he nudges me, will you get up, will you make me an egg? Hay, it would be better if he stabbed me at that moment, let me put it that way. My hackles rise, I mean, I wake up damn it, I'm never a morning person. Oh, and some stuff for me. You know, I don't make eggs, you eat your own cheese and bread or crack an egg. Anyway, of course this marriage is not a one-sided thing. Oh, I've trained myself a little bit in that regard, you know, Sundays are a little more common. For example, if the girl is coming too, if she is at home, we don't set a table on the weekend, and we don't sit at the same table together. Everyone takes a tray in front of the TV or something. Maybe it's a very bad thing. First of all, our eating hours don't match. I eat two meals a day, I have breakfast and I eat 5-6 in the afternoon, that's it. But since he wants to eat three or four meals, there is always something like this, you know, I also have a problem with the kitchen, I mean, I don't like cooking very much, you know, because I don't like to be domestic. That's why there are problems, of course, for example, he is also very curious. I mean, he watches master chef in the evenings, I say "you watch so much master chef and can't you prepare an egg? You're going to prepare an egg, you're going to put oil, you're going to cook it, that's it. You know, he says "I want you to do it". He says "I should eat from your hand" but it actually feels like torture to me. You know, let me suffer. He actually wants me to do something for him. I mean, I don't want to be misunderstood, of course I cook, of course I serve, you know, some needs are met, but do I love it, no. Oh how well I poured my heart out. We can do it every weekend (laughs) I don't know.

Interviewer: [00:38:40 - 00:38:43] I also suggest you start therapy if you have such a need.

Speaker: [00:38:46 - 00:39:04] Actually, I didn't really believe it, but it felt good, I'll admit it. I'll even tell my daughter because she said, "I'm very curious, what are you going to talk about, what are you going to do? So can you share this with her?"

Interviewer: [00:39:05 - 00:39:10] I will not share this information with anyone, I mean it will only be shared for research.

Speaker: [00:39:10 - 00:39:16] I see. So if I say, "I have my approval, send it to my daughter", can that happen?

Interviewer: [00:39:17 - 00:39:22] Uh, I can send it to you at most, if that's your preference.

[00:39:23 - 00:39:25] Can you send it to me and I can show it to my daughter?

Interviewer: [00:39:26 - 00:39:31] So. It is your data and you can share it with whoever you want.

Speaker: [00:39:33] Okay.

Interviewer: [00:39:35 - 00:39:39] So I'll take a note then, create the transcript.

Speaker: [00:39:39] Mail?

Interviewer: [00:39:39 - 00:40:07] Hm? No, transcript. I can get it or I can send it via [Social media]. Now we don't create these transcripts immediately. So it has to go into a computer program. No, that computer program will take them and write them down, and then we will listen to the transcript and the audio recording and go over the transcript to see if it is translated correctly. So after that document is created, I can share it with you if you want?

Speaker: [00:40:08 - 00:40:15] That would be good. I mean, will she see your comment and will you write there too?

Interviewer: [00:40:15 - 00:40:20] No, there will be no comment from me. So I (spoken at the same time)

Speaker: [00:40:20 - 00:40:22] This is going to be recorded, right?

Interviewer: [00:40:22 - 00:41:33] Exactly this will be recorded. So we are not doing this as a psychological evaluation, but rather all this data, all this huge data collected from everyone, there is a method of analysis called thematic analysis. There is a method of analyzing this qualitative data, such as which topics people see as important, which topics come up all the time, what it means. Well, it will be entered into it and such an analysis will be made, so our goal is to try to understand what actually constitutes the relationship, the quality of the relationship, that is, to understand what makes relationships good, what makes relationships bad as humanity, as people, rather than an individual goal, that's why we do so many interviews. We are conducting interviews in so many different countries, trying to reach so many people, so I will not have an evaluation.

Speaker: [00:41:33 - 00:41:58] Okay, then, I mean, I can do something, you know, my daughter because she was curious, you know, because she is a [occupation]. She said she was very curious, I mean, how, what questions will be asked, how will you answer? Maybe she will put the relationship between her mother and father in her own way (laughs).

Interviewer: [00:42:00 - 00:42:06] The reason why. I mean, if you want to share, it is also up to your discretion.

Speaker: [00:42:07 - 00:42:09] Okay. It's fine, so I would like to.

Interviewer: [00:42:10 - 00:42:12] Okay. So I took notes.

[00:42:13] Okay.

Interviewer: [00:42:16] Once the transcript is created, I will share it with you.

Speaker: [00:42:17] Okay.

Interviewer: [00:42:23 - 00:42:26] Do you feel safe in your relationship?

Speaker: [00:42:28] I feel it.

Interviewer: [00:42:29 - 00:42:31] Do you want to open it a little more?

Speaker: [00:42:33 - 00:42:34] But how did you ask?

Interviewer: [00:42:35] How did you understand?

Speaker: [00:42:41 - 00:42:58] How did I understand? I mean. I mean, I understood that if something happened to me, he would run, come, do something, I mean, he would be there for me.

Interviewer: [00:43:00 - 00:43:08] What if something happens? I mean, are we talking about getting physically harmed, do you mean something happening to you?

Speaker: [00:43:08 - 00:44:29] Yes, of course. He is my husband, he should do that much anyway. Although the issue is very radical like this, I mean, I broke my finger a couple of times, I fell, I fell, etc. So of course he took me to the hospital, but for example, if I get sick, he has no tolerance for illness. I have a fever, for example, I have the flu, I mean, in a very strange way, he is very uncomfortable, you know, he doesn't stay at home, he leaves the house, even one day it happened, my fever went up to 39 degrees. I called my friend who we haven't seen for [26-30] years, I said, "I'm dying." He came and took me to the hospital, so REDACTED was out. After that, REDACTED came later and doctor said, you know, it's a good thing you brought her, otherwise she was going to have a seizure or something. You know, he also has those kinds of things, you know, he doesn't believe, you can't be that sick, you know, you're exaggerating, so he has his own fixed idea. But other than that, as I said, God forbid, if something very big happens, of course he would be with me.

Interviewer: [00:44:33 - 00:44:56] Do you feel safe in terms of being able to share your thoughts, ideas, experiences freely? Let me ask you if you feel emotionally safe, without fear of judgment or fear of retaliation.

Speaker: [00:44:57 - 00:45:21] I'm not much of a type, I don't show my feelings much, I don't talk much, I'm a little closed. I like mystery too, to be honest, but you know, I didn't really understand the question very well. How emotional?

Interviewer: [00:45:21 - 00:45:57] It's a vague question on the one hand, so I think you gave the right answer as far as you understand, so the other one is emotionally safe, feeling emotionally safe means feeling safe that you can share, that your posts will not be used against you, that you will not be judged, that what you say will not be used against you. It means feeling free in a sense.

Speaker: [00:45:57 - 00:46:57] That's right. I mean, if we are talking about REDACTED, he won't do such a thing, but I can look at some things that he doesn't like more normally. I mean, as I said, even though he looks a bit more modern, he has a conservative attitude towards certain things, he is starch. He doesn't go out of that mold much, but I can say that it might be normal, I can say, for example, he might be like that, you know, we may not agree in that respect, but it's not valid for every subject, of course, this is valid for specific things. That's how it is.

Interviewer: [00:46:59 - 00:47:25] We are approaching the end of our interview. I'm going to share an image, I'm going to share a powerpoint and I have a couple of questions. If I ask if my partner usually really listens to me. 1, not true at all. 9, completely true. How many would you give me?

Speaker: [00:47:29 - 00:47:30] (Güler) I mean, he never listens. 1.

[00:47:33 - 00:48:18] I mean, if it was zero, I would give zero, so he doesn't listen at all. His problem is not listening to people anyway. I mean, we went to a psychologist for a while, when we had a child, there was always a problem. We went to a psychologist and he took it separately, not as couple therapy. He said REDACTED that he should do the [redacted] rule. Stop, listen, think, act. You know, he doesn't stop, doesn't think, doesn't listen and does something, that is, he jumps right away, creates something in his own head and responds to it, so I can give this a minus two or something.

Interviewer: [00:48:20 - 00:48:32] Okay. I took a note. If I ask if my partner is usually sensitive to my needs. 1, not true at all. 9, completely true. How many would you give?

Speaker: [00:48:38 - 00:48:07] Responsive. You know, does my partner meet my needs or something like that. Sensitivity is a different thing, I mean, I don't think he is sensitive, so let me say it a little bit right, I mean, does he meet my needs, ok. But whether he is sensitive is something related to emotion. So let's say it's a little bit true, let's not be too unfair.

Interviewer: [00:49:08] 3 so.

Speaker: [00:49:10] 3.

Interviewer: [00:49:11 - 00:49:12] Why not 2?

Speaker: [00:49:13 - 00:49:15] Ha 2 can we also give it?

Interviewer: [00:49:15 - 00:49:19] 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9.

Speaker: [00:49:19 - 00:49:24] I got it. I got it. No, there was something. One is not right at all. 3 is a little bit right. It says 1, 3, 5. (unclear)

Interviewer: [00:49:24 - 00:49:26] No, you can also give them.

Speaker: [00:49:27] 3.

Interviewer: [00:49:28] Why not 2?

Speaker: [00:49:31 - 00:49:36] Okay, dear, let's not be unfair, he is not that much of a person, I mean he is a good person.

Interviewer: [00:49:36] Why not 4?

Speaker: [00:49:38 - 00:49:47] Okay, let's skip this question. I mean then why not 5, why not 6. Is he sensitive? Well, a little bit sensitive. It is.

Interviewer: [00:49:49 - 00:49:59] If I ask you how satisfied you are with your relationship in general. I said completely satisfied, very dissatisfied, somewhat dissatisfied, not sure, undecided, somewhat satisfied, very satisfied, completely satisfied.

Speaker: [00:50:09 - 00:50:29] So I'm not very satisfied, I'm not very satisfied, I'm not sure, I'm not sure, it could be all of them. I mean, it can even be a little bit satisfied. How satisfied am I a little bit? Let's say I'm a little bit satisfied or I can say I'm undecided.

Interviewer: [00:50:34 - 00:50:45] Okay. That one. Question. On a scale of minus ten to plus ten, between being completely dissatisfied and completely satisfied, how many would you give?

Speaker: [00:50:52 - 00:51:06] So how would I rate it? I'm not completely dissatisfied, I'm not satisfied, so I would probably give it a two.

Interviewer: [00:51:06 - 00:51:07] Plus two?

Speaker: [00:51:08 - 00:51:12] Yes. Am I being too unfair?

Interviewer: [00:51:15 - 00:51:16] I don't know, I don't know

Speaker: [00:51:16 - 00:51:32] why? you met (laughs). If he showed his true face, which he did. Let's say two. Let's say two, two or three. Let's say three, let's not be rude.

Interviewer: [00:51:38 - 00:51:50] Well, I'm looking. I'm looking to see if there's a question I missed. That's it. I'll close this.

Speaker: [00:51:51] Is that so?

Interviewer: [00:51:52] Yeah.

Speaker: [00:51:54] Okay.

Interviewer: [00:51:56 - 00:52:48] Tell me about the thing. We have one or two issues left. One, how will this data we collect from you be used? Uh, two, before we close, I would like to summarize what we talked about so that if there is something missing, if you want to add something, if I misunderstood something, if you want to correct it, I would like to give you the opportunity. First of all, let's eliminate the data, the bureaucratic work. There are three options. One is to say, I don't want this data to be used. You can do it after [6-10] months, you can do it after [1-5] month, you can do it after [1-5] year, you can do it after [1-5] month. If in any way you change your mind about the use of the data we collect from you, you tell us. If you tell us, we delete this data as if it never happened.

Speaker: [00:52:49 - 00:53:54] I mean, as I mentioned at the beginning, I accepted to come, we are talking.

Speaker: [00:52:54] Right

Speaker: [00:52:56 - 00:53:03] Well, I'm not that psychotic. Uh, no, I regret it. I don't know, wipe them off.

Interviewer: [00:53:04] I'm just saying. I mean, because.

Speaker: [00:53:05 - 00:53:10] Okay. Like I said, I only have one thing. You know, just erase the video.

Interviewer: [00:53:11] Exactly.

Speaker: [00:53:12 - 00:53:15] A, delete my name blah, blah, blah, blah.

Interviewer: [00:53:15 - 00:53:55] It will be de-identified. Ah, then de-identified, that is, your name, your spouse's name, where you work, where you live, although you didn't say these things anyway. We haven't talked about any identifying information other than your name. Oh, if I remember correctly. These will be removed if and when they are found. You can choose to share the entire written transcript that will be produced, you can choose to share all of it, or you

can tell me that you can share only parts of it. Do I understand that in this case we can share the whole thing?

Speaker: [00:54:55] Exactly.

Interviewer: [00:54:56 - 00:54:01] Okay, great. Thank you.

Speaker: [00:54:02 - 00:54:03] You're welcome. Thank you very much.

Interviewer: [00:54:04 - 00:54:07] I am summarizing what we talked about.

Speaker: [00:54:07] Please.

Interviewer: [00:54:08 - 00:59:45] You are [56-60] years old. You've been together [26-30] years. It's about to be [26-30]. You have a [26-30]-year-old daughter. Well, your mother has been living with you for [1-5] years, since your father passed away. Your daughter lives with her boyfriend. She visits from time to time. You are a retired [occupation]. You said that you did [occupation] for a while after you retired from the [company]. Now you continue to play the [company] with your own savings. You met your wife at the [company]. You met in the queues. You met in the queues and started a relationship and then a friend of yours became the middleman. Dinners, movies, vacations. On the first date, you said that you said that he put his hand on your hand and asked you what you thought about your relationship, you said that he asked. When you said I don't know which relationship, you said that he said I think a lot of things. Then you mentioned that your age was appropriate, that you were [26-30] years old, so you got married, and that you had children because everyone around you had children after having children, and you had children because you were of age to have children. Well, you mentioned that [26-30] years of relationships, [26-30] years of togetherness is difficult, that you were very worn out in your relationship. You said that you had many points in the middle at the time, but over time even your musical tastes stopped matching. You mentioned more than once that your relationship turned into a roommate relationship. You said he changed a lot. You said that while he was a delightfully calm person, he became grumpy and aggressive. Over time, you said that you also became aggressive. You said that his being angry also made him angry. You mentioned that you quarreled too often. You said that you were worn out. You said that you started to prove these things. In a sense, you said that you argue like a straw flame, that you explode and go out, that you don't care too much, that you try not to give a damn. You said it was a question mark whether you were happy or not. Well, you said that one of the important, one of the important factors in the continuation of your relationship is that it is important that you are modern and that you claim your own space. You said that if this was not happening, if your freedom was being restricted in any way, you would not be here. You mentioned that you hadn't even gone on vacation together for the last [1-5] years, that the last time you went on vacation you fought a lot, you fought all the time, and then you stopped going on vacation together, that everyone went on vacation with their friends. You mentioned that you didn't sleep together because he snored, and that when you didn't sleep together, things broke down. You explained that everyone lived their own lives. You know, he was completely different, he was like a delight. You said that he was very nice to the outside world, that he made a lot of effort not to offend people, but that you felt that he didn't show the same care and devotion towards you. And when you did, you said that he didn't accept it. Therefore, you said that the solution in your relationship is to destroy, to ignore, to live as if the problems do not exist because it is not possible to talk. When I asked you what is the most important thing in a relationship, what makes a relationship quality, you said that it is to understand each other. Love, respect, trust are

of course important factors, but they are all things that arise from understanding and trying to understand, none of them are as important as understanding. You said that being on the same frequency, being on the same page, enjoying common things, being able to do common things, being able to share, having areas of sharing are the most important things for a relationship. You said that you had [1-5] or [1-5] other relationships before your husband, that you were engaged once, but that you had one more relationship before that, but that these relationships were not comparable to your current relationship, that they were children's relationships, that this was a [26-30]-year marriage and that you could not even imagine how they could be compared. When I asked you what love is, you told me that love is passion, sexuality, butterflies in the stomach, longing, excitement, a curtain falling over your eyes. You said it has a life span, that it ends. But you said that even though it ends, even though it changes shape, the relationship is the most important thing. You mentioned that if there is no love left, the remaining things are not done with desire. You mentioned that you don't have a sex life. When I asked you what is the most important thing for you in a relationship, I guess that's what I asked, you said trust and peace. Well, you mentioned that your husband is very obsessive and that the washing machine is the biggest culprit in his house.

Speaker: [00:59:46] Dishwasher.

Interviewer: [00:59:46 - 01:59:49] Sorry, the dishwasher. Dishwasher.

Speaker: [00:59:49 - 00:59:51] Let's not sin the laundry (laughs).

Interviewer: [00:59:52 - 01:03:20] You mentioned that the period when there was no dishwasher was much more peaceful, that it caused conflict to the point of not wanting to have it repaired, preferring to wash by hand. You explained that without peace, trust and love don't matter much, that you want peace in your life and that you have difficulty finding it, that you retreat to your own spaces to find it, that you go on vacation with your friends, rest, calm down, gather energy and return to your relationship. You said that the fact that neither of you chose to divorce is a sign that something is still keeping you together. You mentioned that you still feel love and longing, that not everything is over, that there is not much respect left, that respect is worn out in a place where there is so much arguing and yelling. You mentioned that you continued to drink together from time to time. When I asked you how a person knows when they are loved, you said they know. He knows from the look in his eye, from the look in his eye, from what he feels inside. It has no concrete, tangible data. You said it is an intuitive thing. When we were talking about how often you have conflicts, you mostly mentioned that you have conflicts every day, that there is always tension, that an issue that causes tension flares up, that your conflicts are not resolved, they don't go anywhere, so they are swept under the carpet. You mentioned that you are like a straw flame, that after swearing and yelling for 10 minutes, you pour a glass of wine, say how are you and somehow continue your relationship as if it didn't happen. Exactly ... (unintelligible) we didn't put the dishwasher. So when I asked you how a relationship lasts, what makes a relationship last, you said understanding. You said that understanding, peace is very important. Because you said that you feel that you don't have it. In a sense, you said that you realized its importance or felt its importance because it wasn't there. You talked about how your meal times don't match, how the places where you are numb are decreasing. You reiterated once again that the fact that you do not interfere in your own space and that he does not attempt such an intervention is also an important factor in the continuation of your relationship. You talked about your discussions about food. You said that you cooked and served without really liking it. You mentioned that you felt safe in your relationship, that if

something happened to you, he would come running, you knew he would come running. But let's say you mentioned that they have a habit of illness. How much you are being listened to, when you talk about feeling safe, sharing feelings, you mentioned that you are not a person who shares your feelings very much. That's why you said you feel safe in general. You said that if you could give one minus two for rest, you would give minus two. About the profit of your needs, being sensitive to your needs.

Speaker: [01:03:20 - 01:03:27] I'm sorry, he has no ear No ear organ (laughs). Please make a note of that. He was born without an ear.

Interviewer: [01:03:31 - 01:03:53] You gave three points about being sensitive to your needs. When I asked you how satisfied you are with your relationship, you said undecided. When I gave you a broader scale, you gave me a two. Well, I made a note that when our transcript is created, I will share it with you when it is created. We had such an interview.

Speaker: [01:03:54 - 01:03:58] It was very good for me. I don't know if I was productive for you?

Interviewer: [01:03:58 - 01:04:02] It was definitely fruitful. Everything you said is very valuable for us.

Speaker: [01:04:02 - 01:04:09] Good, great then. By the way, can I ask, how many pairs does this thing work on?

Interviewer: [01:04:11 - 01:04:47] Well, we are trying to collect 25 couples from Turkey. It is not clear if we will reach. We are trying to collect relationships of different durations. So 5 couples less than one year, 5 couples between 1-5 years, 5 couples between 5-10 years, 5 couples over 20 years. Likewise, we are trying to collect 20-25 couples each in America, the Philippines, Brazil and France. A project with a caftan. In other words, because they are trying.

Speaker: [01:04:47 - 01:05:55] Yes, it is. I thought it was only couples who have been together for more than 20 years. Huh, okay.

Interviewer: [01:04:55 - 01:05:18] So that's why humanity, all of us together, are trying to understand what we understand from the relationship as human beings. They are also trying to gather information from different cultures to understand the differences between cultures. I'm not going to say that we are doing something just because we set foot in Turkey, that's exactly what we are doing.

Speaker: [01:05:18 - 01:05:34] It's beautiful. It's very nice. I mean, it had a relaxing effect on me. And you have such a positive energy. I liked that a lot too. Thank you too.

Interviewer: [01:05:34 - 01:05:39] Thank you. Thank you for everything you have shared. Then take care of yourselves.

Speaker: [01:05:40 - 00:05:45] See you soon, so when can we do this thing?

Interviewer: [01:05:45] Transcript?

Speaker: [01:05:46] Mm-hmm (Confirms).

Interviewer: [01:05:47] Eee.

Speaker: [01:05:49 - 01:05:52] There is no hurry, of course, you know, more or less a week, [6-10] days, [1-5] months.

Interviewer: [01:05:53 - 01:06:00] I don't know the thing. That's why I'm saying it won't take [1-5] months. Because the project will have to move forward. It will have to go through analysis.

Speaker: [01:05:58 - 01:06:02] Okay, okay. It's fine, whatever. So you don't have to answer this.

Interviewer: [01:06:02] No.

Speaker: [01:06:03] You don't know.

Interviewer: [01:06:03 - 01:06:24] It's not that. We are not the ones who own the eee license to the eee program, the program we will use. They give it to us because they are the main managers of the project, a gentleman from the Philippines. He will put it in. So it is up to his convenience and arbitrariness.

Speaker: [01:06:25] Got it.

Interviewer: [01:06:27] But I took notes.

Speaker: [01:06:28] Okey thank you very much.

Interviewer: [01:06:31] I thank you for everything.

Speaker: [01:06:31 - 01:06:35] So I'll see you soon. Take care. You too.

Interviewer: [01:06:34] Take care.